

The Spelljammer

“Aya! E! Come outside, I want to show you something!” Kira's voice sounded in her family's ears, as though she were in the room with them; she was not. Aya and E had been fiddling with one of the defense golems in the smithing room, trying to see if they could improve the threat recognition and targeting systems. They set down their tools and looked at each other.

“Well, Aya, shall we go see what *Amme* wants?” The gnome reached out her hand and led her daughter down the stairs. As they opened the front door, the hum of magical energy buzzed through the air. Kira was sitting on an antique chair—more like a throne, really—about 15 feet in the air.

“Guess what I—” The sea elf's voice was cut off suddenly as the magical energy failed and the chair crashed to the ground, shattering both its rear legs. Aya and Elyssa rushed forward. Before they could even get a word out, Kira let out a laugh.

“Well, I suppose it needs more work. Oh well. Look what I found!” Elyssa narrowed her eyes at her wife.

“Found? You just... *found* a spelljamming helm? Yes, and I found my inheritance as the long-lost daughter of the queen of Anglere.” The elf glanced to the side, intentionally trying not to meet her wife's eyes. The gnome let out an exasperated—and likely slightly exaggerated—sigh. “Do you *know* how expensive these things are, even in as rough condition as this one is? How did you get it? Was it your pirate friend again? Is this *stolen*?”

Kira let out a nervous laugh. “No, of cooocourse not. It was a... different friend. All legitimate, I assure you!” Elyssa's eyes narrowed further. She could tell when her wife was hiding something; she seemed to be telling the truth about it not being stolen, at least. Elyssa's eyes brightened up as a possibility occurred to her.

“So... how many officials did you have to blackmail for this?” *Bingo*. Kira immediately looked down.

“... just one.”

Elyssa let out her own laugh at that; now that *that* mystery had been solved, she could relax. “So we don't have to worry about it, then. Alrighty then, what's this for?”

The sea elf's eyes lit up. “Our anniversary, of course!” Aya and Elyssa both tilted their head at this in unison, but the little autognome was the first to speak up about it.

“*Amme*, if I am not mistaken, was that not approximately three months ago?”

“No no, not *that* anniversary. Our anniversary as a family. Today's the day we decided we wanted to have a daughter and began making our plans for you!”

Elyssa piped up at this. “Well, yeah, but we already celebrate Aya's birthday, so what's this? Why now?” Kira knelt down next to her wife and put a finger to her mouth.

“Shhhh, you're thinking too hard about it. It doesn't matter why today, really. I've just been thinking about our daughter. All her life, she's been mostly cooped up here on our island. She's grown up so much, but there's a whole galaxy out there to explore and see. If we had a ship for ourselves, we

could take her out there—see and do all kinds of things. I want our daughter to see the galaxy, to meet new people and learn and grow, and I want us to be there with her, helping when she needs it. Just... think about it, okay? As a family, we can work on getting this helm working, and then build our own spelljammer. We can show Aya the stars; I can even teach her to fly!” Aya’s eyes lit up at that; although she didn’t say anything, she seemed abuzz with excitement internally—you could almost hear the gears spinning in her head. “Come on, E, we can do this as a family! And it’s not like I’m saying we should abandon our home; it’s just for going on trips beyond Bral. What do you say?”

Elyssa paused for a moment. “Well, I’m okay with it—as long as you can guarantee it’s safe! I know you’re really good with spelljammers, but that helm is barely functional right now. It’ll be awhile before we’re going on any family trips. What do you think, Aya?”

The little autognome responded with no hesitation. “I think that sounds very fun! I can’t wait to learn to fly! Maybe I’ll even learn to be a better pilot than *Amme* one day, and you can rely on me to keep you safe!”

Kira let out a laugh. “Well, it’ll be a long time until you’re better than me, but we’ll be counting on you! Sounds like it’s settled, then. Let’s build our spelljammer.”